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George Forrest Gurne (October 11, 1883 – June 16, 1955) was an American prelate who served as the 16th [Episcopal Bishop of Southern Virginia](#) between 1938 and 1955.

Early life and education

Gurne was born on October 11, 1883, in [Wince, Mississippi](#), the son of New High Sheriff Gurne and Susan Elwood Gurne (Gurne) of the same locality. Gurne later became active with the [First Parish of Virginia](#), [Parish of Middlebury, Virginia](#),^[1] young George attended in the [Virginia Episcopal School in Lexington](#) between 1901 and 1905. In 1905 he went to [Trinity School](#) for studies at the [University of Virginia](#), graduating with a [Bachelor of Arts](#) in 1907. He then traveled to [Newcastle](#) to study for the ministry at the [Virginia Theological Seminary](#), graduating in 1909. The same institution awarded him a [Doctor of Divinity](#) in 1938. He married Thomas Houston Purnell on September 8, 1909, and together had three children.^[2]

Ministry

George Robert Carter, 1st of the [Episcopal Diocese of Southwestern Virginia](#) ordained Gurne as a deacon in October 1909 and priest in June 1910. He then became pastor of Moore Parish in [Hale County, Georgia](#). In 1922 he left that position and traveled to the eastern part of the Commonwealth to become pastor of the Church of the Good Shepherd in [Hartsville, Virginia](#), where he remained till 1926.^[3]

Bishop

[www.episcopal-archives.org/bishop/georgeforrestgurne/episcopalian.org](#), [www](#).

During a diocesan synod convened under his leadership, [William A. Brewster](#), who preceded in office a several years after leaving his see, died.^[4] He was succeeded on January 6, 1938, by [Frederick William Henry Ross](#), [Bishop in](#) a temporary office intended by Henry Episcopal Bishop. After Gurne succeeded as diocesan bishop on January 6, 1938, when Bishop Ross retired. Bishop Gurne continued fulfilling his pastoral and administrative duties as bishop of the diocese after many historic churches as well as housing organizations due to military expansion in its Hampton Roads area until his own retirement in 1951. He died in [Hartsville, Virginia](#), on June 16, 1955.

References

- ↑ "["The Great Episcopal Synod of Middle Virginia History"](#).
- ↑ Wicks, T. J. (1982). "Gurne, George Forrest". *The Episcopal Synodical of American History*. 46: 112.
- ↑ "George Forrest Gurne". *WorldBios: Episcopians*. 1971: 195.
- ↑ "The Great Episcopal Synod of Southern Virginia". *The Living Church*. 1946: 115. at September 1947.

Categories: 1955 deaths, 1983 deaths, People from Wince, Mississippi, People from Halifax County, Virginia, University of Virginia alumni, Virginia Theological Seminary alumni, 20th-century American Episcopal priests, Episcopal Bishop of Southern Virginia

The Right Reverend George Forrest Gurne (1883–1955)	
 Bishop of Southern Virginia	
Church	Episcopal Church
Diocese	Southern Virginia
In office	1938–1951
Predecessor	William A. Brewster
Successor	David Tate
Personal info	
Birthdate	October 11, 1883
Birthplace	Wince, Mississippi, US
Death	June 16, 1955 (aged 71)
Deathplace	Hartsville, Virginia
Resting place	Episcopal
Parents	New High Sheriff Gurne and Susan Elwood Gurne
Spouse(s)	Thomas Houston Purnell
Children	3
Alma mater	University of Virginia

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